

OMB Control No: 0970-0114

Expiration date: 03/31/2027

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**Appendix 1: Lead Agency Implementation Plan
for**

State/Territory Missouri

FFY 2025 – 2027

Version: Initial Plan

Plan Status: Approved as of 2024-11-09 00:55:03 GMT

For each non-compliance, Lead Agencies must describe the following:

- **Action Steps:** List the action steps needed to correct the finding (e.g., update policy manual, legislative approval, IT system changes, etc.). For each action step list the:
 - o **Expected Completion Date:** List the expected completion date for the action step.
- **Overall Target Date for Compliance:** List date Lead Agency anticipates completing implementation, achieving full compliance with all aspects of the findings. (Note: Compliance will not be determined until the FFY 2025-2027 CCDF Plan is amended and approved).

ELIGIBILITY AND ENROLLMENT:CONTINUITY OF CARE (12-MONTH ELIGIBILITY)

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not appropriately allow temporary changes in work, training, or education status, as required by 98.21(a)(1)(ii)(B), 98.21(a)(1)(ii)(C), 98.21(a)(1)(ii)(D), and 98.21(a)(1)(ii)(E). (Plan Question 2.5.2b)
- The Lead Agency's policies for discontinuing assistance due to a parent's non-temporary change do not meet CCDF requirements, as required by 98.21(a)(2). (Plan Question 2.5.3bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Finalize policies for discontinuing assistance, to be effective March 1, 2025	02/17/2025
2	Staff training on updated policies	02/28/2025
3	Message to stakeholders	02/28/2025
4	Public comment period for amendment	03/31/2025
5	Plan amendment to 2.5.2b	04/30/2025

ELIGIBILITY AND ENROLLMENT:PRIORITIZATION OF POPULATIONS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not have a grace period for children experiencing homelessness and children who are in foster care to receive CCDF assistance while providing their families with a reasonable time to take any necessary actions to comply with immunizations and other health and safety requirements, as required by 94.41(a)(1)(i)(C). (Plan Question 2.3.3bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Established and implemented grace period by adding the requirement to the subsidy provider terms and conditions, applicable to all subsidy providers regardless of number of children served.	10/01/2024
2	Send updated terms and conditions to regional office for review to determine compliance.	11/20/2024
3	Message to stakeholders	02/28/2025
4	Public comment period for amendment	03/31/2025
5	Plan amendment to 2.3.3bi	04/30/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:AFFORDABILITY

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not limit all family co-payments to seven percent or less of family income, as required by 98.45(l)(3). (Plan Question 3.1.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.
- The Lead Agency does not provide data on the extent to which CCDF providers charge families additional amounts above the required co-payment (including data on the size and frequency of such amounts), as required by 98.45(b)(5). (Plan Question 3.1.2eii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 09/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Determine fiscal impact for limiting co-payments	03/31/2025
2	Create survey to collect data on additional amounts providers charge families above the required co-payment	06/30/2025
3	Stakeholder engagement	06/30/2025
4	Survey child care providers	01/30/2026
5	Stakeholder engagement	01/30/2026

6	Create policy on limiting co-payments to 7% family income to be effective August 1, 2026	01/30/2026
7	Update to Child Care Data System (CCDS) based on new policy	06/30/2026
8	Create and finalize report based on survey results	06/30/2026
9	Train staff and providers on new policy and CCDS updates	06/30/2026
10	Message to stakeholders	06/30/2026
11	Public comment period for amendment	07/31/2026
12	Plan amendment to 3.1.1a and 3.1.2eii	09/30/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not pay all providers in a timely manner. In addition, the Lead Agency does not pay all provider types prospectively or alternatively does not demonstrate that it is not a generally-accepted practice for all provider types, as required by 98.45(m)(1). (Plan Question 4.4.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.
- The Lead Agency does not pay based on enrollment or alternatively does not provide justification that this is impracticable or is not a generally-accepted practice, as required by 98.45(m)(2). (Plan Question 4.4.1b). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.
- The Lead Agency does not pay for reasonable mandatory registration fees that the provider charges to private-paying parents, as required by 98.45(m)(4). (Plan Question 4.4.2b)

Overall Target Completion Date: 09/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Determine fiscal impact for paying providers prospectively, paying on enrollment, and paying mandatory registration fees.	03/31/2025
2	Stakeholder engagement	01/30/2026

3	Create policies on paying providers prospectively, paying on enrollment, and paying registration fees to be effective August 1, 2026	01/30/2026
4	Updates to Child Care Data System (CCDS) based on new policies	06/30/2026
5	Train staff and providers on new policy and CCDS updates	06/30/2026
6	Message to stakeholders	06/30/2026
7	Public comment period for amendment	07/31/2026
8	Plan amendment to 4.4.1a., 4.4.1b., and 4.4.2.	09/30/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT RATES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency did not use a market rate survey or ACF pre-approved Alternative Methodology to set payment rates and does not certify that the percentiles reported in their CCDF Plan are based on their most recent MRS or ACF pre-approved Alternative Methodology, as required by 98.45(d)(1) and 98.45(f)(2)(i). (Plan Questions 4.2.1ei, 4.2.1eii, 4.2.1eiii, 4.2.1eiv, and 4.3.2b)
- The Lead Agency has not yet completed the narrow cost analysis or estimated cost of care, as required by 98.45(f)(1)(ii). (Plan Questions 4.2.2a, 4.2.2b, 4.2.2c, and 4.2.2d)
- The Lead Agency's payment rates for infants in family child care homes, preschoolers in family child care homes, preschoolers in center-based care, and infants in center-based care are not sufficient to ensure equal access as they are not based on the most recent MRS, as required by 98.45(a). (Plan Question 4.3.2a)

Overall Target Completion Date: 09/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Finalize and post 2024 MRS on website and begin narrow cost analysis	03/01/2025
2	Message to stakeholders	03/01/2025
3	Public comment period for amendment	03/31/2025

4	Plan amendment to 4.2 to include updated final report information	04/30/2025
5	Stakeholder engagement	06/30/2026
6	Message to stakeholders	06/30/2026
7	Complete narrow cost analysis	06/30/2026
8	Update payment rates based on 2024 MRS	07/31/2026
9	Public comment period for amendment	07/31/2026
10	Plan amendment to 4.2 and 4.3.	09/30/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:PROVIDER OPTIONS FOR PARENTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide grants or contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities, as required by 98.30(b)(1). (Plan Questions 4.1.1c and 4.5.1i). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 09/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Request technical assistance	01/31/2025
2	Explore EHS blending and braiding funding, PPEC, and infant/toddler network	06/30/2025
3	Stakeholder engagement	06/30/2026
4	Review needs assessment data to assist in creating policy on implementing grants and contracts for children in geographic areas and children with disabilities	06/30/2026
5	Message to stakeholders	06/30/2026
6	Public comment period for amendment	07/31/2026
7	Plan amendment to 4.5.1i	09/30/2026

HEALTH AND SAFETY:CHILD DEVELOPMENT

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require pre-service or orientation training on child development for licensed centers, licensed family child care homes, license-exempt centers, or license-exempt family child care homes, as required by 98.44(b)(1)(iii). (Plan Question 5.4.1I)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers or licensed family child care homes or an annual inspection for license-exempt centers or license-exempt family child care homes for compliance with pre-service or orientation training requirements related to child development, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B) and 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii, 5.5.1bii, 5.5.2ai, and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Established and implemented training on child development by adding the requirement to the subsidy provider terms and conditions, applicable to all subsidy providers.	10/01/2024
2	Child development training added to annual inspection report.	10/01/2024
3	Sent updated terms and conditions to regional office for review to determine compliance	11/20/2024
4	Message to stakeholders	03/01/2025
5	Public comment period for amendment	03/31/2025
6	Plan amendment to 5.4.1	04/30/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS AND RESPONSE PLANNING

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency standard for emergency preparedness and response planning does not include continuity of operations for licensed centers or licensed family child care homes, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(vii). (Plan Question 5.3.7ix)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers or licensed family child care providers or an annual inspection for license-exempt centers providers for compliance with a standard for emergency preparedness and response planning, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B) and 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii, 5.5.1bii, and 5.5.2ai)

Overall Target Completion Date: 09/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Stakeholder engagement	04/30/2025
2	Rule amendment to add continuity of operations to emergency plan for licensed providers	06/30/2026
3	Message to stakeholders	06/30/2026
4	Public comment period for amendment	07/31/2026
5	Add to annual inspection report	07/31/2026
6	Plan amendment to 5.3.7ix	09/30/2026

HEALTH AND SAFETY:HANDLING AND STORAGE OF HAZARDOUS MATERIALS AND DISPOSAL OF BIOCONTAMINANTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for the appropriate disposal of biocontaminants for licensed centers or licensed family child care homes, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(viii). (Plan Questions 5.3.8bi and 5.3.8bii)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers or licensed family child care providers for compliance with a standard for appropriate disposal of biocontaminants, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii and 5.5.1bii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Message to stakeholders	02/28/2025
2	Public comment period for amendment	03/31/2025
3	Plan amendment to 5.5.1aii and 5.5.1bii to add the standard already in place for biocontaminants	04/30/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:POSTING INSPECTION REPORTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not post full monitoring and inspection reports that include all areas of compliance and non-compliance for all licensed centers, licensed family child care providers, license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, license-exempt in-home providers, or out-of-school programs, as required by 98.33(a)(4). (Plan Question 5.5.4a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for portions of this requirement through August 1, 2026.
- The Lead Agency monitoring and inspection reports do not contain all the required elements, specifically corrective actions taken by the State and child care provider, as required by 98.33(a)(4). (Plan Question 5.5.4b)

Overall Target Completion Date: 09/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Complete self-assessment for posting child care monitoring inspection reports	06/30/2025
2	Create inspection reports in the Child Care Data System (CCDS)	03/31/2026
3	Testing for new inspection reports	06/30/2026
4	Message to stakeholders	06/30/2026
5	Public comment period for amendment	07/31/2026
6	Plan amendment to 5.5.4b	09/30/2026

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PREVENTION AND CONTROL OF INFECTIOUS DISEASES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for immunizations for all licensed centers, licensed family child care providers, license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care homes, license-exempt in-home providers, or out-of-school programs serving, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(i). (Plan Questions 5.3.1bii and 5.3.1bv)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers or licensed family child care providers, or an annual inspection for license-exempt centers or license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for immunizations, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B) and 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii, 5.5.1bii, 5.5.2ai, and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 06/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Continue discussions with the Department of Health and Senior Services to update statute	06/30/2025
2	Through collaboration with DHSS, revise the statute to be compliant	09/30/2026

PROGRAM INTEGRITY:FRAUD INVESTIGATION, PAYMENT RECOVERY, AND SANCTIONS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not identify the sanctions on clients or providers in response to fraud, as required by 98.68(b)(2). (Plan Question 10.2.2e)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Update and finalize sanctions for families and providers	02/17/2025

2	Train staff on updated policies	02/28/2025
3	Message updates to stakeholders	02/28/2025
4	Public comment period for amendment	03/31/2025
5	Plan amendment to 10.2.2e	04/30/2025